



Kindle Paperwhite

The latest version of Amazon's Kindle Paperwhite is now available in India for ₹10,999. <http://dgit.in/KindleZon>



AMD launches Kaveri

New line of APUs to offer improved performance power efficiency. <http://dgit.in/AMDkaveri>

Agent 001

Q Smarthone needed

I'm planning to buy an Android phone under ₹13,000. There are a lot of choices available in the market and I'm confused. My requirements are: screen size should be 4.5" or above, at least a 1.2GHz processor, 720p HD display, 1GB RAM, 4GB of minimum internal storage with memory card slot. Also, please tell me which phone is better from amongst the Micromax Canvas Magnus and the XOLO Play.

Naveen Santosh

A Out of the two smartphones, we would say that the XOLO Play is a nicer option as it performs better, has an NVIDIA Tegra CPU as compared to the Canvas Magnus which has a Mediatek processor. If you keep your options open, you can also take a look at the XOLO Q1000 or the Q1000S both of which fall in the same price range and are decent phones.

Q Headphones under 5k

Hi, I need help in buying a new pair of headphones and my budget is ₹5000. After researching for some time, I've set down five different options to choose from and they are: Sennheiser HD439, Sennheiser HD449, Koss Portapro, Grado SR80i and the Sony MDR-XB600.

The looks of the headphones matter to me and I usually listen to hip-hop, metal and pop music. Please advise the best set headphones that I can get in my budget.

Zayed Saquib

A As you said that you like to listen to hip-hop, metal and pop, your choice of music basically covers the entire gamut of our test spectrum. Anyway, since you haven't mentioned whether you are looking for portability or not, we'd like to say that the XB600 and the Portapro are portable while you can also carry around the Grado SR80i if you wish, because they're compact too and sound nice as well. As for the Sennheiser's, they're circumaural so they would not be passable as portable headphones but they're decent for inhouse use. We'd like to recommend the Koss Portapro to you, as it's a timeless design and because the looks of the headphones matter to you. The sound quality of the portapro is

brilliant and the headphones themselves are very comfortable for prolonged use as well. The Red version of the Portapro is available on ebay.in for ₹3800. Go for it.

Q Gaming laptop wanted

I want to buy a laptop and so I'm searching for one. The primary purpose of this laptop would be gaming and Photoshop. I'm really confused between the HP Envy 15-j001tx and the Dell Inspiron 15 - 7537 (Core i7 and NVIDIA GT750). Please recommend a good one.

Shubhanshu Agarwal

A There is a significant price difference between the HP Envy and the Dell Inspiron as the Envy is priced higher than the Inspiron by about 20k. But for the price difference, there is not much of a difference when it comes to performance between the two. This is why the Inspiron 15 - 7537 is a better option in terms of value for money. However, the Envy 15-j001tx has a full HD display and if that is something that is very important for you and you can afford to pay a premium price of ₹85,000, only then you should go for it but remember that the Inspiron would still be a better buy.

Q Dual band router with USB

Hi, I'm interested in buying a new router and I have the following requirements:

- Should have up to 2-4 ethernet ports;
- Should have WiFi so that I can connect laptops and other portable devices;
- Dual band would be preferable;
- Should have in-built USB port for media sharing.

Also advise whether an 802.11ac or a 802.11n would be better?

Sunil Rajput

A Since you haven't mentioned any particular price bracket, we'll enlist some good routers from different price categories that should meet your criteria. First is the TP-LINK TD-8968. Available for ₹2,500, TD-8968 is a single band n-router with a maximum bandwidth of 300Mbps. Next is the Belkin N600 DB which is a dual-band n-router and is available for ₹4,100. As the name suggests, the router supports a maximum bandwidth of 600Mbps and is a

well rounded router. But if you want the best of the best and go all out, then you should consider the ASUS RT-AC68U which sells for ₹19,500 and is an extremely feature-rich router. At the end of the day, it all boils down to whether you require that many features. If not, then our first suggestion i.e., the TP-LINK TD-8968 would suffice. Finally, about the difference between an 802.11ac and 802.11n router is that, the ac is just an upgrade to the older standard. The 802.11n standard was limited by bandwidth, but it kind of served as a draft for the ac standard with improved speeds and also many other aspects such as less interference.

Q Which IEM?

I want to buy a good pair of earphones and I zeroed-in on the Sennheiser CX-180 and the Tekfusion Twinwoofers. I've read a few reviews online on forums by audiophiles which say that the Tekfusion Twinwoofers are a good set, but I'm still confused about which one to go for. Please advise.

Sushil Kumar



A Let's look at the Sennheiser CX-180 first. Although a decent budget IEM, we think it's a little over-rated. Same goes for the Tekfusion Twinwoofers because they also sound decent for budget IEM's but aren't really superlative. We would recommend you to take a look at the Cowon EMI as those are a great set of earphones. Our tests showed that they're well balanced and provide a good sound response. You'll get the non-mic variant of the Cowon EMI for around ₹900 and the mic variant for ₹1200 which is a pretty decent deal considering you get tangle-free cables and fairly decent build quality. You should definitely try the Cowon EMI and you won't be disappointed. **T**